back into universal use, and in the fifteenth century French totally disappeared.

The Loss of Normandy

The first link in the chain binding England to the continent was broken in 1204 when King John lost Normandy. John married Isabel of Angouleme (1200). As far as the reason of this marriage is concerned, he loved her and had certain political advantages in mind as well. She was at the time formally betrothed to Hugh of Lusignan, the head of a powerful and ambitious family. John, anticipating hostility from the Lusignans, attacked them. They appealed for redress to their common overlord, the king of France. In this entire context, Philip saw an opportunity, and summoned John (1202) to appear before his court at Paris. However, John said, as the king of England he was not subject to the jurisdiction of the French court. Now this was a point of contention. On the day of the trial the English king did not appear in the court and the court declared his territory confiscated. Philip proceeded at once to carry out the decision of the court and invaded Normandy. Soon John's supporters deserted him, and finally Normandy was lost to the English crown.

What was the impact of the loss of Normandy? In fact, as far as English language is concerned, it was advantageous for English language. Now England emerged as a first concern. England was on the way of becoming not merely a geographical term but once more a nation.

Topic – 072: Nobilities & French Reinforcement

Loss of Normandy had Certain Consequences

It brought to a head the question of whether many of the nobility owed their allegiance to England or to France. After the Norman Conquest, a large number held lands in both countries. A kind of interlocking aristocracy existed, so it might be difficult for some of the English nobility to say whether they belonged more to England or to the continent. Some steps toward a separation of their interests had

Question # 10 of 10 (Start time: 04:15:20 PM, 28 November 2023)

Loss of Normandy in 1206 proved to be_____ as far as English is concerned.

Select the correct option

- disastrous
- damaging
- advantageous
- catastrophic

Click to

7:33 PM

uncultivated

Topic – 069: The Attitude Toward English

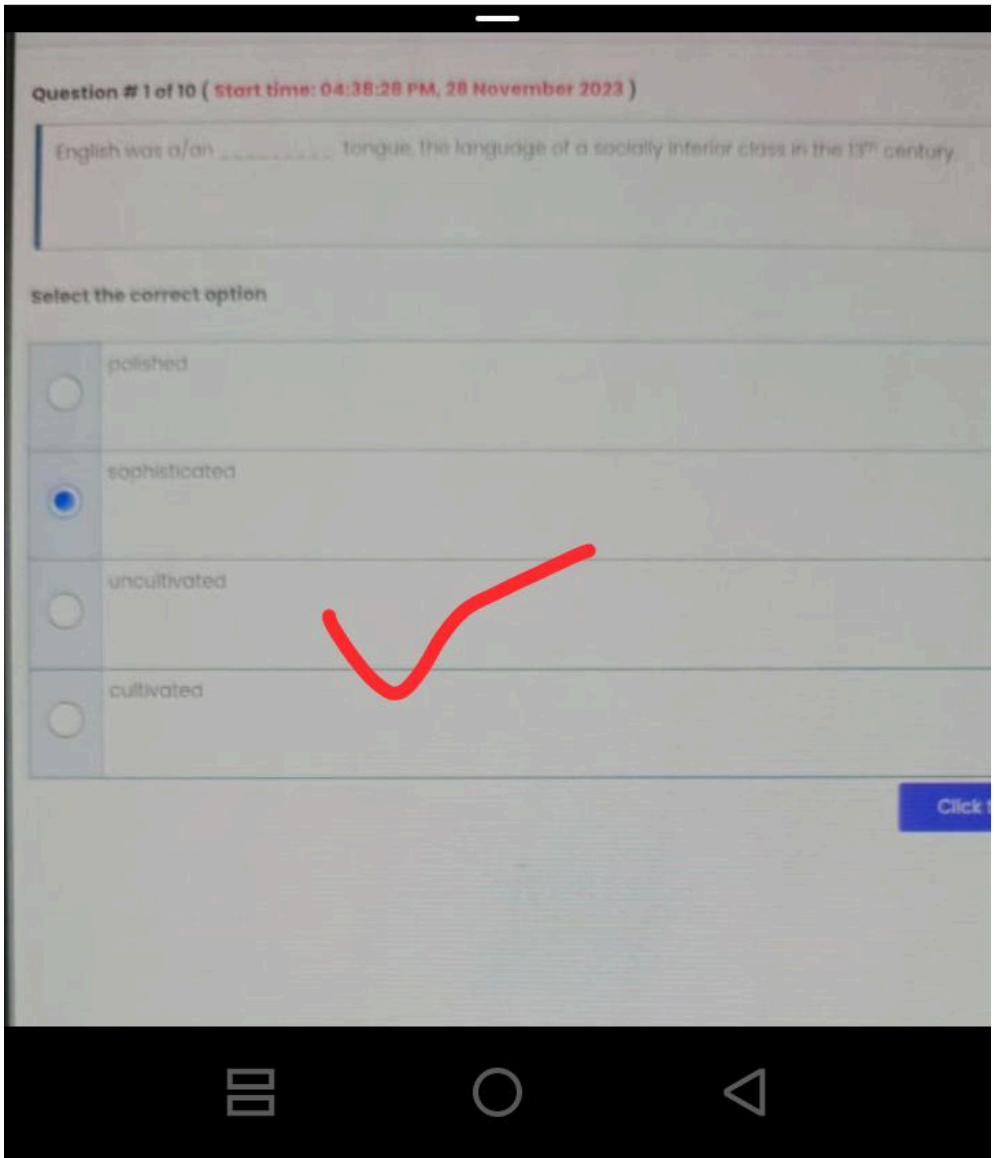
There is no reason to think that the preference that the governing class in England showed for French was anything more than a natural result of circumstances. The idea that the newcomers were actively hostile to the English language is without foundation. It is true that English was now an uncultivated tongue, the language of a socially inferior class. This session also discusses that till 1200 what was happening? What was the attitude of the king and the upper classes? Why they were indifferent? What were the reasons of indifference? They did not cultivate English, though had acquaintance with it. The reason was that their activities in England did not necessitate it. Their constant concern with continental affairs made French useful.

Topic – 070: Fusion and Diffusion of French and English

In the years following the Norman Conquest, the sting of defeat and the hardships incident to so great a political and social disturbance, they were gradually forgotten. People accepted the new order as something accomplished. They accepted it as a fact and adjusted themselves to it. The fusion of Normans and English was rapid, but not more rapid than national interest. When a distinction is made, it soon comes to be between the English, meaning all people of England, and the French, meaning the inhabitants of France. This early fusion of French and English in England is quite clear from a variety of evidences; for instance, one of the examples is marriages of Normans to English women.

Evidence

In (1072 – 1079) Wulfstan brought about some sort of spiritual federation between the monks of Worcester and six other English monasteries. In short, Norman nobles identified themselves with their new country, founded monasteries, and chose burial in their adopted land rather than in Normandy.



7:32 PM

polite

- Its ability to convey thoughts in a vivid form
- Its ability to record emotions

The literature of the Anglo-Saxons is the richest and the most significant of any preserved literatures among the early Germanic people. Two types of this literature were brought to England by the Germanic conquerors from their continental homes and preserved in oral tradition. It is influenced by reintroduction of Christianity into the southern part of the island at the end of the sixth century. Two streams mingle in Old English literature; these are pagan and the Christian. Both the traditions constantly overlay.

Topic – 062: Old English Literature: Semantics & Syntax

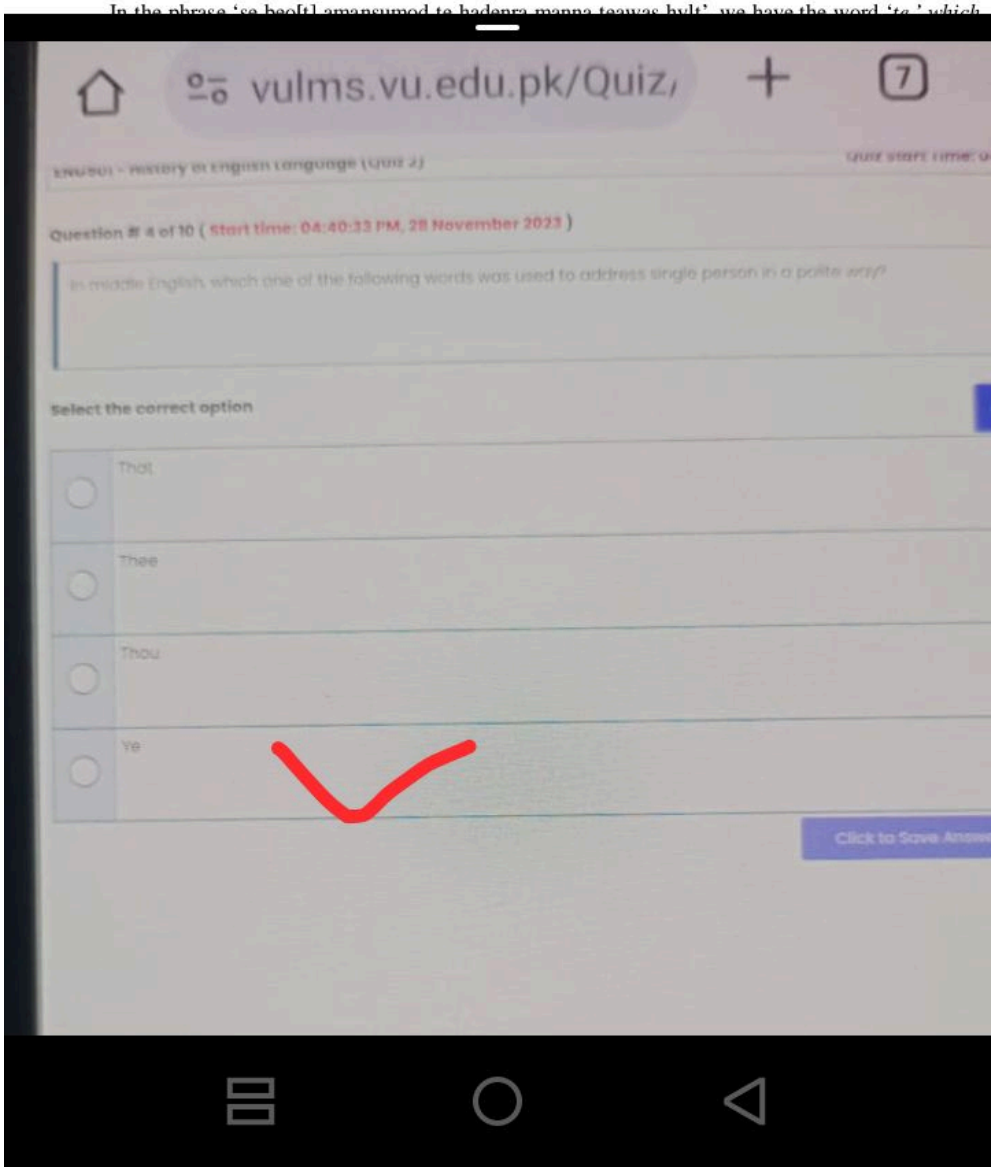
Use of Pronouns: *tū (singular)- gē (plural)*

Today we use *you* in both cases. In Old English, *thou and thee* were singular and *ye and you* were plural, but in Middle English times the custom arose of using *ye/you* as a polite or deferential way of addressing a single person, and this usage spread; *thou and thee* gradually [illegible] out of use in everyday speech, and finally [illegible]ared (except in some dialects, where they persist to this day).

The topic also provides certain examples to prove the points. For example:

- I say also to you, brother Eadweard, now you me of this
- Ic secge eac de, brodor Eadweard, nu du me tyses
- Asked, that you do unrighteously that you the
- Bade, tat ge dod unrihtlice tat ge da
- English customs abandon which your fathers held and
- Engliscan teawas forlætad te eowre faderasheoldon
- And heathen men's customs love who
- Hadenra manna teawas lufiad te
- Notice how relative clauses are introduced.

In the phrase 'se be[t] amansumod te hadenra manna teawas hylt', we have the word '*te*' which



7:03 PM

127 B/s

51

french remained

To cut it short, William had won the battle of Hastings, but had not yet attained the English crown. However, when the Southeast of England was burnt and the citizens of London surrendered, he was crowned on Christmas Day 1066.

Following important points about The Norman Settlement are worth readable:

- William's victory at Hastings was more than a mere substitution of one monarch for another.
- Norman prelates were gradually introduced into all important positions in the church. For example, the two archbishops were Normans. Also, English abbots were replaced.
- In 1075, 13 out of 21 abbots who signed the decrees of the Council of London were English. Interestingly twelve years later only three were left.

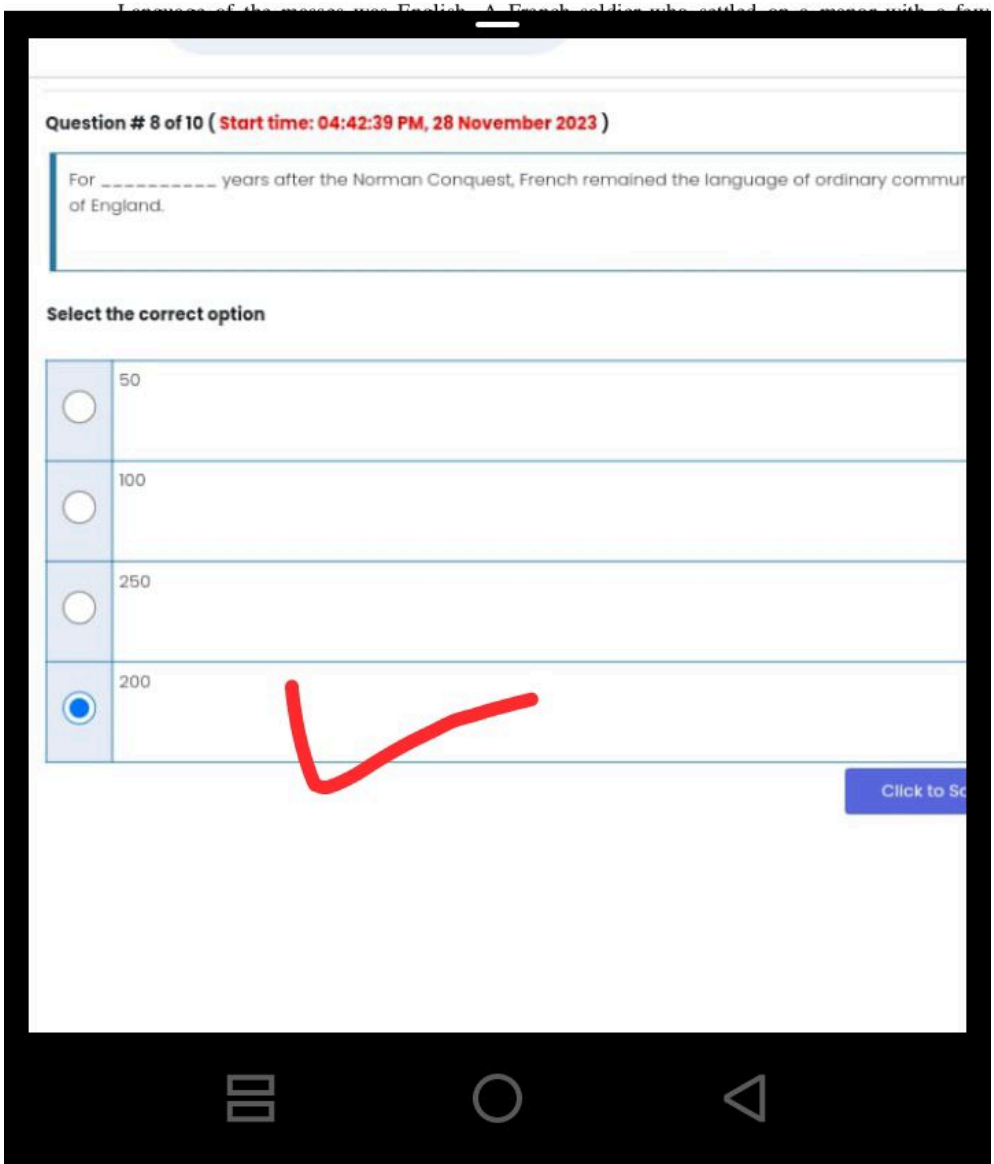
Topic – 068: Use of French Language and Literature

The Use of French by the Upper Class

The members of the new ruling class were sufficiently predominant to continue to use their own language. This was natural enough. For 200 years after the Norman Conquest, French remained the language of ordinary intercourse among the upper classes in England.

French Spread Through

- Intermarriage
- Association with the ruling class: numerous people of English extraction found it to their advantage to learn French
- Distinction was not ethnic but was largely social



7:01 PM

47 B/s 52

latter part of

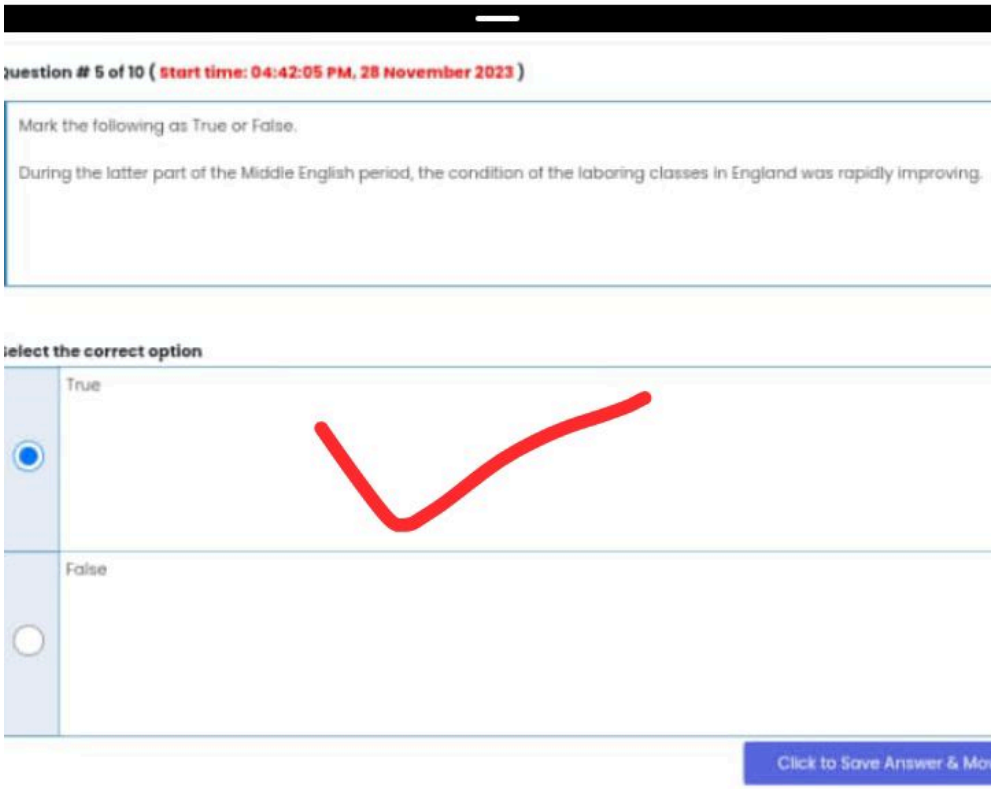
odds at Agincourt (1415). But the success did not continue after the young king's death, and the exploits of Joan of Arc (1429) marked the beginning of the end. Probably the intervals between the periods of actual fighting were too long and the hindrances to trade and other interaction too discouraging. The feeling that remained uppermost in the minds of most people was one of animosity, coupled with a sense of the inevitability of renewed hostilities. It was impossible to forget that French was the language of an enemy country Hundred Years' War is probably to be reckoned as one of the causes contributing to the disuse of French.

Topic – 075: The Rise of the Middle Class

What helped English to recover its former prestige?

- Improvement in the condition of the masses
- Rise of a substantial middle class

Since importance of a language largely depends upon the importance of people who speak it; with the rise of middle class English also had uplift in its status as their language. During the latter part of the Middle English period, the condition of the laboring classes was rapidly improving. Among the rural population villeinage was dying out. Fixed money payments were gradually substituted for the days' work. The process by which these changes were being brought about was greatly accelerated by an event that occurred in the year 1349. This event is known in the history as 'The Black Death'. It was in the summer of 1348 that in the Southwest of England, first case of this plague was reported. These were the first cases of a disease that in its contagiousness and fatality exceeded anything previously known. The Black Death spread rapidly over the rest of the country, reaching its height in 1349.40 percent of the parish clergy died of the plague. Death rate during the plague approximated 30 percent. The effects of so great a calamity were naturally serious. Mortality was greatest among the lower social orders. The question arises why mortality was greatest among the lower social orders. The answer is simple: it happened because their life style was poor, hygiene conditions were bad and affordability to medicine was very low. The result of these deaths was a labor shortage which consequently gave rise to increase in wages.



6:58 PM

968 B/s 52

was eaten up

been taken from time to time. On several occasions, Henry I confiscated the English estate Norman barons. But in 1204, the process of separation was greatly accelerated, for by a decre 1205 the king of France announced that he had confiscated the lands of several great barons. F part, the families that had estates on both sides of the Channel were compelled to give up one c Sometimes they divided into branches and made separate terms. Sometimes great nobles pre larger holdings in England and gave up their Norman lands. An incident in 1244 sped up the pr was the address of king of France. He asserted: 'As it is impossible that any man living in m and having possessions in England, can competently serve two masters, he must either insepar himself to me or to the king of England.' So people had to relinquish their properties either in in France. Knowing this, the king ordered that all people of the French nation, and especially who had possessions in England, should be disseized of them. After 1250, there was no rea nobility of England to consider itself anything but English, and the most valid reason for its us was gone.

French Reinforcements

This was the time of foreign invasion. This is when the country experienced a fresh foreigners, this time mostly from the south of France. In short, in the course of Henry III's (1216–1272), the country was eaten up by strangers. Even London was full to overflowing Poitevins, Romans, and Provengals but [redacted] of Spaniards who did great injury to the Eng French reinforcement took place.

Topic – 073: English & French in the 13th Century

The thirteenth century must be viewed as a period of shifting emphasis upon the two spoken in England. The upper classes continued for the most part to speak French, as they had previous century, but the reasons for doing so were not the same. Shift of French from a mo inherited from Norman ancestors to a cultivated tongue took place. It was supported by social by business and administrative convention.

Question # 2 of 10 (Start time: 04:41:21 PM, 28 November 2023)

In the course of Henry III's long reign (1216–1272), the country was eaten up by _____

Select the correct option

- (●) strangers
- ( ) travelers
- ( ) foreigners
- ( ) local people

6:57 PM

36 B/s 52

language of the court

acquaintance with it. The reason was that their activities in England did not necessitate it. Th concern with continental affairs made French useful.

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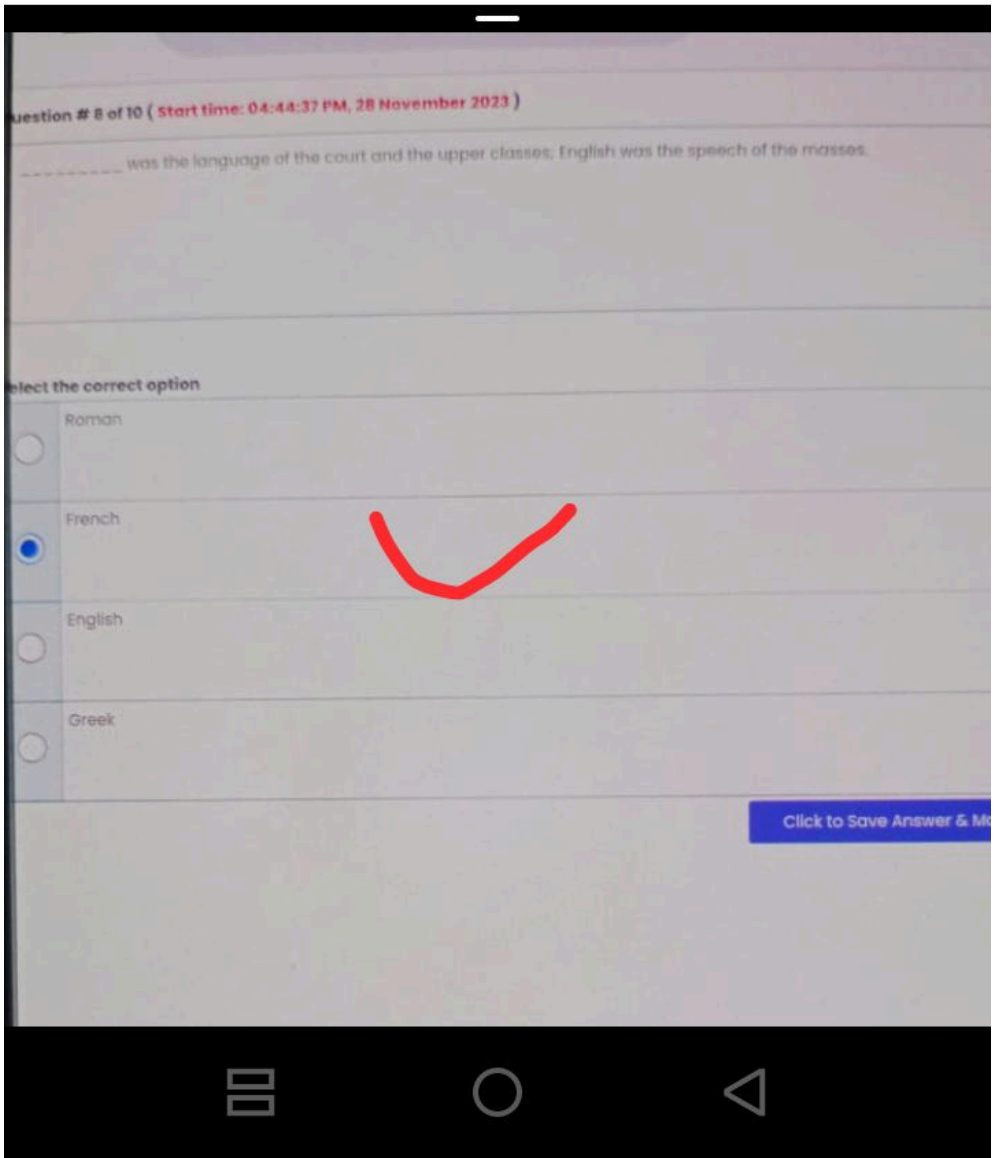
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The fusion seems to have gone forward rapidly in the reign of Henry I. 'Now that the l Normans have been dwelling together, marrying and giving in marriage, the two nations have mixed that it is scarcely possible to-day, speaking of free men, to tell who is English, who race.' French was the language of the court and the upper classes, English the speech of the people.

The question to be asked is really twofold:

(1) When and how generally did the upper class learn English?

(2) How far down in the social scale was the knowledge of French at all general?



6:57 PM

357 B/s

thou and thee

- Its full power
- Its ability to convey thoughts in a vivid form
- Its ability to record emotions

The literature of the Anglo-Saxons is the richest and the most significant of any preserved literatures among the early Germanic people. Two types of this literature were brought to England by the Germanic conquerors from their continental homes and preserved in oral tradition. It is influenced by reintroduction of Christianity into the southern part of the island at the end of the sixth century. Two streams mingle in Old English literature; these are pagan and the Christian. Both the traditions constantly overlay.

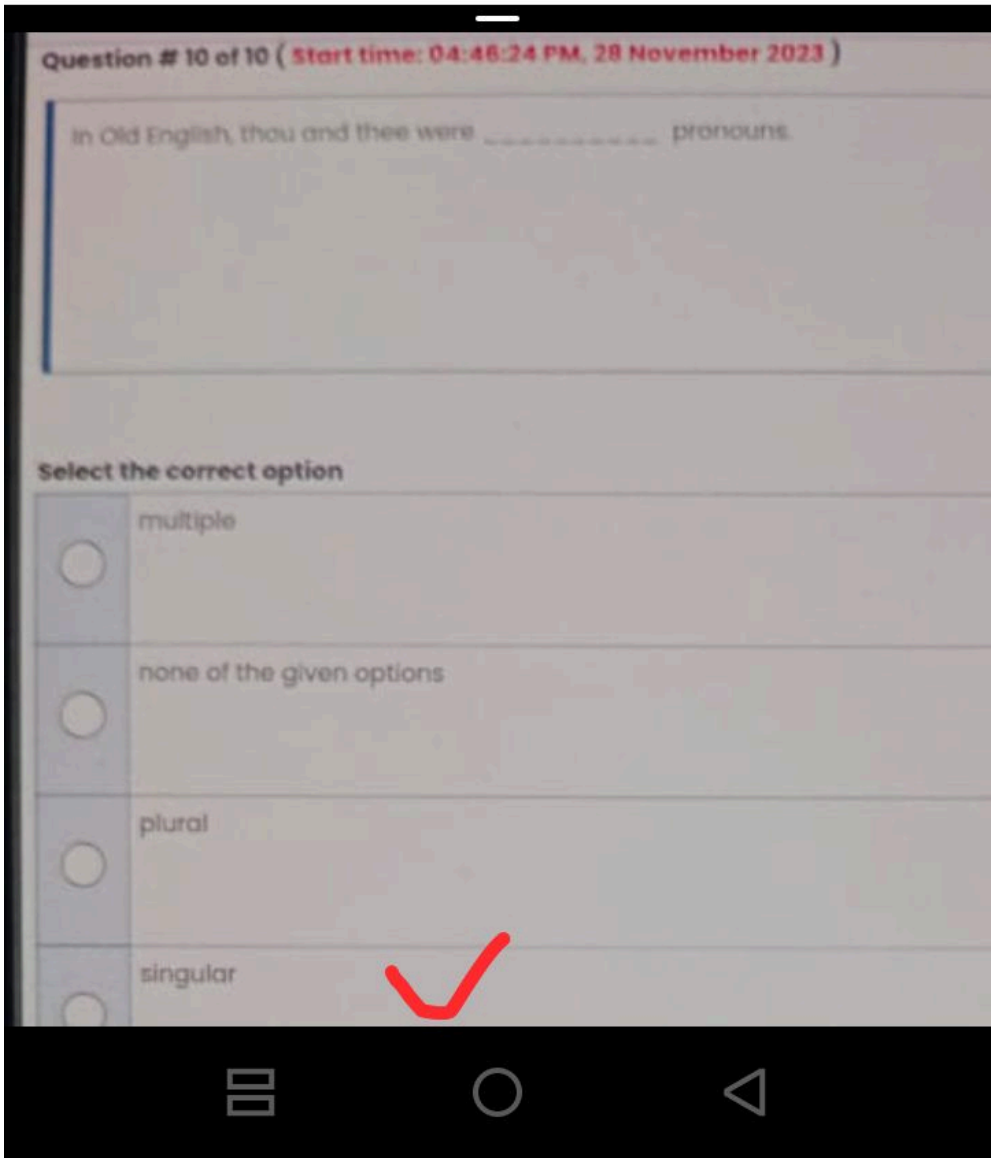
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Use of Pronouns: *tū (singular)- gē (plural)*

Today we use *you* in both cases. In Old English, *thou and thee* were singular and *ye and you* were plural, but in Middle English times the custom arose of using *ye/you* as a polite or deferential way of addressing a single person, and this usage spread; *thou and thee* gradually dropped out of use in everyday speech, and finally disappeared (except in some dialects, where they persist to this day).

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- Bade, tat ge dod unrihtlice tat ge da
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- Engliscan teawas forlætad te eowre faderasheoldon
- And heathen men's customs love who
- Hadenra manna teawas lufiad te
- Notice how relative clauses are introduced.



6:56 PM

110 B/s 52

adoption of

This was the time of foreign invasion. This is when the country experienced a fresh invasion of foreigners, this time mostly from the south of France. In short, in the course of Henry III's long reign (1216–1272), the country was eaten up by strangers. Even London was full to overflowing not only of Poitevins, Romans, and Provengals but also of Spaniards who did great injury to the English. Thus, French reinforcement took place.

Topic – 073: English & French in the 13th Century

The thirteenth century must be viewed as a period of shifting emphasis upon the two languages spoken in England. The upper classes continued for the most part to speak French, as they had done in the previous century, but the reasons for doing so were not the same. Shift of French from a mother tongue inherited from Norman ancestors to a cultivated tongue took place. It was supported by social custom and by business and administrative convention.

Meanwhile, English made steady advances. By the middle of the century, when the separation of the English nobles from their interests in France had been completed, English was becoming a matter of general use among the upper classes. Adoption of French words into the English language took place. There was shift in literature as well. All that was written in French was now translated into English. By the close of the century, some children of the nobility spoke English as their mother tongue and had to be taught French through the medium of manuals equipped with English glosses. The knowledge of French, even of those who attempted to use it in this period was scanty.

Topic – 074: The Hundred Years' War

In the course of the centuries following the Norman Conquest, the connection of England with the continent had been broken. It was succeeded by a conflict of interests and a growing feeling of antagonism that culminated in a long period of open hostility with France (1337–1453). The active interference of France in England's efforts to control Scotland led Edward III to finally put forth a claim to the French throne and to invade France. The great victories of the English at Crécy (1346) and Poitiers (1356) fanned English patriotism to a white heat, though this auspicious beginning of the struggle was

ENG501 - History of English Language (Quiz 2) Quiz Start Time: 04:56 PM,

Question # 2 of 10 (Start time: 04:57:48 PM, 28 November 2023)

Adoption of _____ words into the English language took place in the 13th century.

Select the correct option

- Italian
- Roman
- French
- Greek

Click to Save Answer & Move to

6:55 PM

33 B/s

richest

Lesson 13

DISCUSSION ON SAMPLES OF OLD ENGLISH

Topic – 061: Old English Literature: Phonology & Morphology

In literature, a language displays:

- Its full power
- Its ability to convey thoughts in a vivid form
- Its ability to record emotions

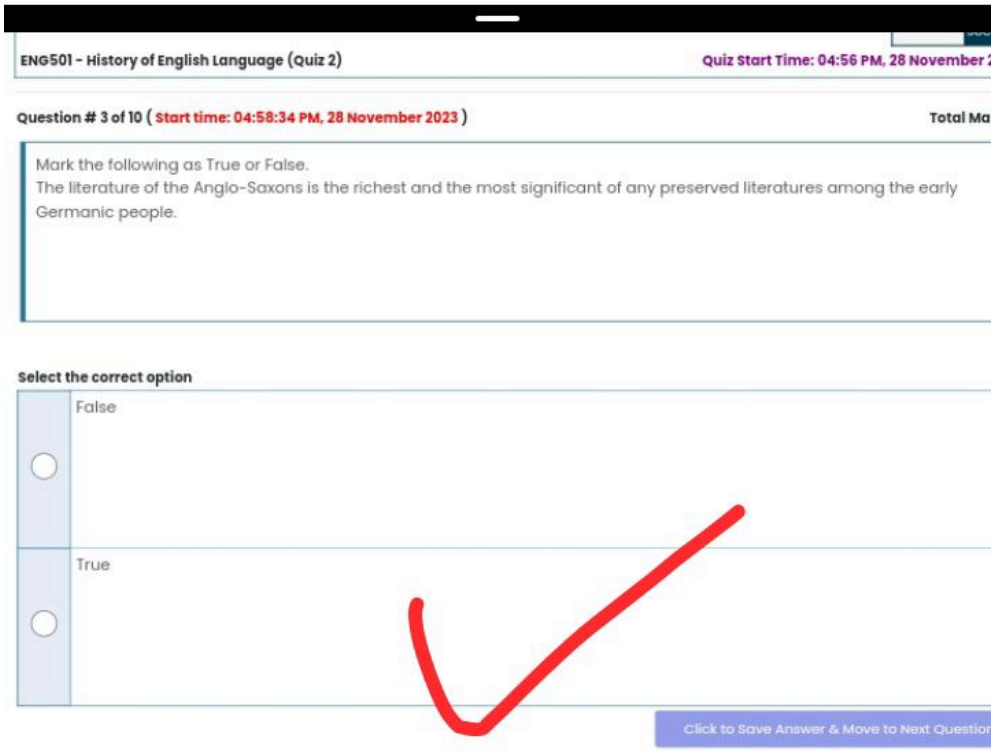
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The topic also provides certain examples to prove the points. For example:



6:54 PM 212 B/s 52

civilization of Normandy

Topic – 067: Origin of Normandy &Norman Settlement

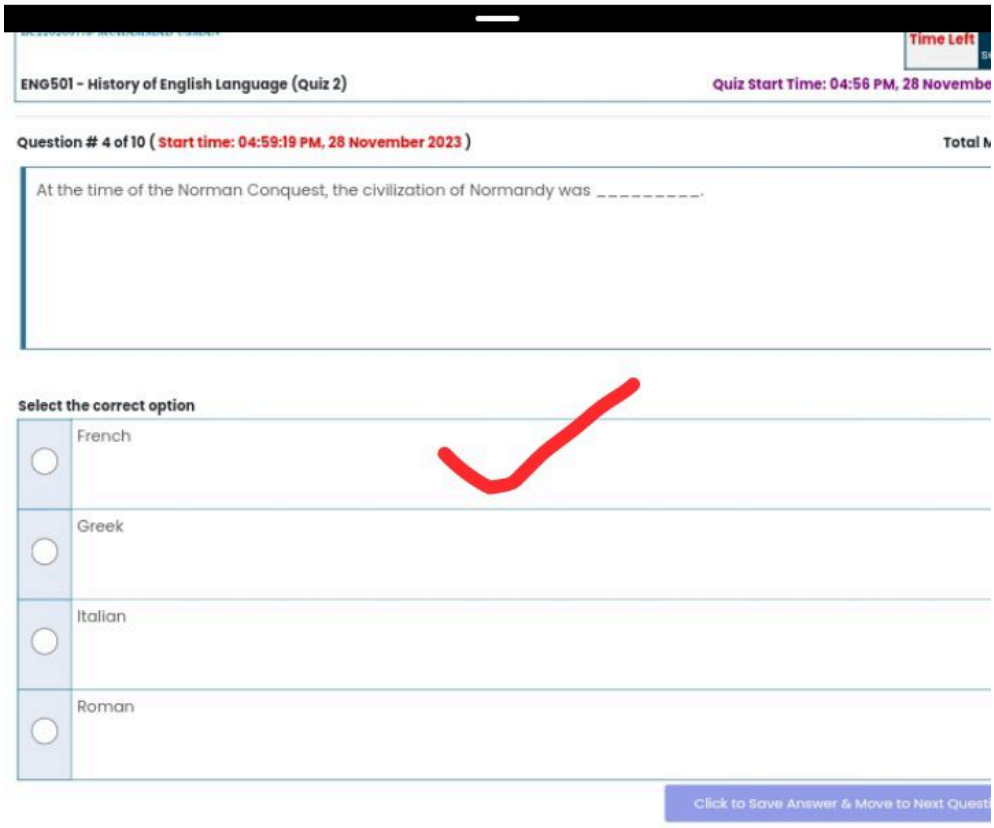
Normandy: on the northern coast of France, directly across from England, a district extending some seventy-five miles back from the Channel. The name is derived from the bands of North-men who settled there in the ninth and tenth centuries. A generation after, Alfred reached an agreement with the North-men in England; a somewhat similar understanding was reached between Rollo, the leader of the Danes in Normandy, and Charles the Simple, king of France.

The next one and a half centuries witnessed how masterful dukes raised the dukedom to a position of great influence. Normans readily adopted the French civilization. They injected fresh vigor into what they borrowed, profited from French military forces and took important features of Frankish law. Accepted Christianity and constructed Norman cathedrals. Locals gave up their own language and learned French. Consequently, Old Scandinavian tongue disappeared rapidly. Second duke sent his son to Bayeux to learn something of the speech of his forefathers.

11th Century

At the time of the Norman Conquest, the civilization of Normandy was French. Normans were most advanced people. Before Norman Conquest, there was a close contact between the two people. Æthelred (1002) married a Norman wife and during exile took refuge at the duke of Normandy. His son Edward, brought up in France, was more French than English. In 1042, Edward the Confessor was restored to the throne and he supported Norman friends. The result of all this was a strong French atmosphere. In this context, Edward died childless; it led to the issue of choice of a successor. Godwin, earl of the West Saxon emerged as successor, but he was challenged by William, the duke of Normandy.

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92 B/s

civilization of Normandy

Topic – 067: Origin of Normandy &Norman Settlement

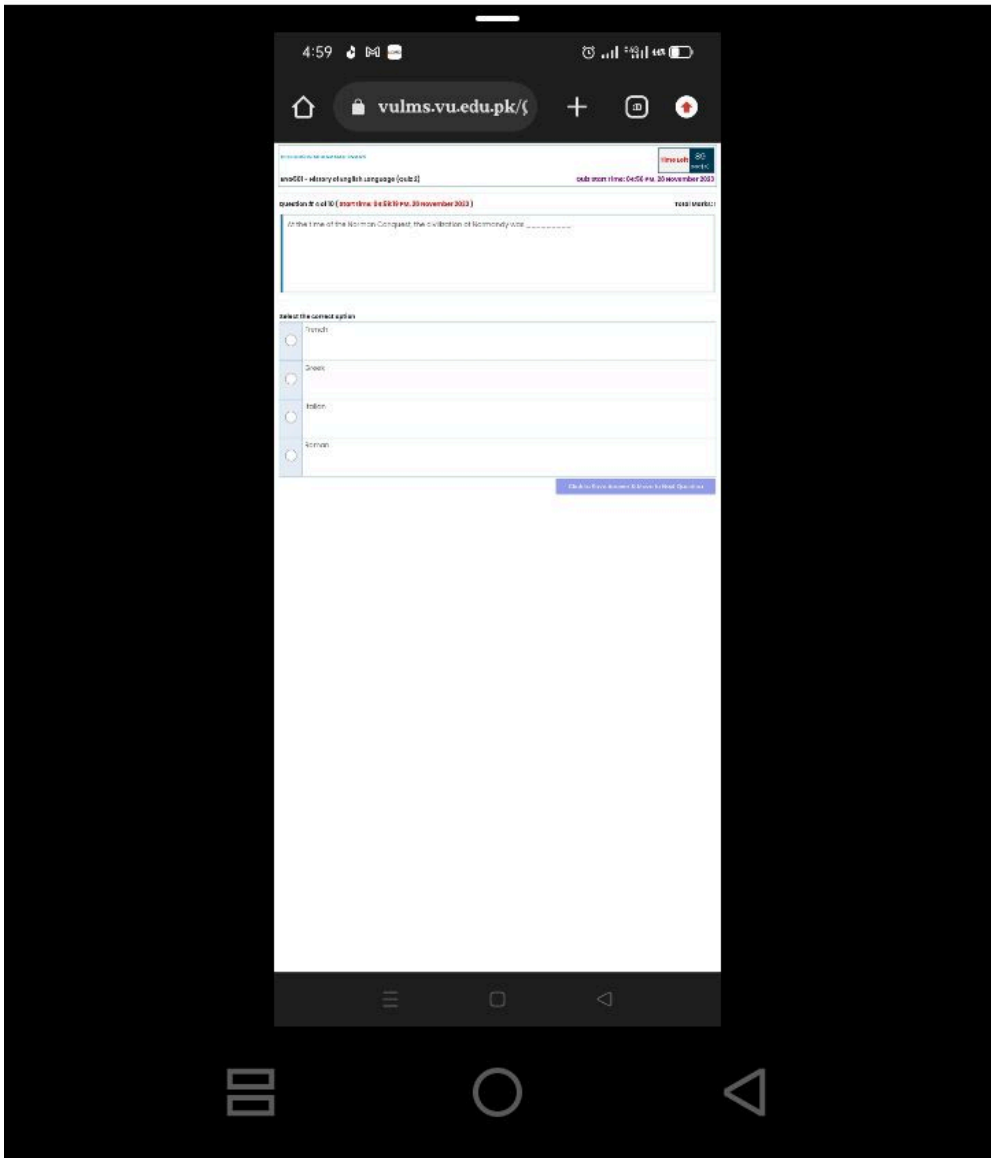
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382 B/s 52

estates of unruly

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been taken from time to time. On several occasions, Henry I confiscated the English estates of unruly Norman barons. But in 1204, the process of separation was greatly accelerated, for by a decree of 1204–1205 the king of France announced that he had confiscated the lands of several great barons. For the most part, the families that had estates on both sides of the Channel were compelled to give up one or the other. Sometimes they divided into branches and made separate terms. Sometimes great nobles preferred their larger holdings in England and gave up their Norman lands. An incident in 1244 sped up the process. This was the address of king of France. He asserted: 'As it is impossible that any man living in my kingdom, and having possessions in England, can competently serve two masters, he must either inseparably attach himself to me or to the king of England.' So people had to relinquish their properties either in England or in France. Knowing this, the king ordered that all people of the French nation, and especially Normans, who had possessions in England, should be disseized of them. After 1250, there was no reason for the nobility of England to consider itself anything but English, and the most valid reason for its use of French was gone.

French Reinforcements

This was the time of foreign invasion. This is when the country experienced a fresh invasion of foreigners, this time mostly from the south of France. In short, in the course of Henry III's long reign (1216–1272), the country was eaten up by strangers. Even London was full to overflowing not only of

ENG501 - History of English Language (Quiz 2) Quiz Start Time: 04:56 PM, 28 N

Question # 5 of 10 (Start time: 05:00:06 PM, 28 November 2023)

On several occasions, Henry I confiscated the _____ estates of unruly Norman barons.

Select the correct option

- English
- Italian
- Roman
- Greek

Click to Save Answer & Move to Ne

6:52 PM

89 B/s

53

england culminated

Lesson 15

THE RE-ESTABLISHMENT OF ENGLISH IN MIDDLE ENGLISH PERIOD

Topic – 071: Changes After 1200 & Loss of Normandy

Changing Conditions After 1200

The change in conditions after 1200 led to the re-establishment of English during the period of 1200–1500. Shortly after 1200 conditions changed. England lost an important part of its possessions abroad. The nobility gradually relinquished their continental estates. This led to a feeling of rivalry that developed between the two countries. An anti-foreign movement in England culminated in the Hundred Years' War. During the century and a half following the Norman Conquest, French had been not only natural but also more or less necessary to the English upper class. However, in the thirteenth and fourteenth centuries its maintenance became increasingly artificial. For a time, certain new factors helped it to hold its ground, socially and officially. Meanwhile, social and economic changes affecting the English-speaking part of the population were taking place. In the fourteenth century, English won its way back into universal use, and in the fifteenth century French totally disappeared.

The Loss of Normandy

The first link in the chain binding England to the continent was broken in 1204 when King John lost Normandy. John married Isabel of Angouleme (1200). As far as the reason of this marriage is concerned, he loved her and had certain political advantages in mind as well. She was at the time formally betrothed to Hugh of Lusignan, the head of a powerful and ambitious family. John, anticipating hostility from the Lusignans, attacked them. They appealed for redress to their common overlord, the king of France. In this entire context, Philip saw an opportunity, and summoned John (1202) to appear before his

uestion # 7 of 10 (Start time: 05:02:10 PM, 28 November 2023) Total Marks:

An anti-foreign movement in England culminated in the _____ years' war.

elect the correct option

ten

hundred

twenty

fifty

Click to Save Answer & Move to Next Question

6:51 PM

33 B/s

richest

DISCUSSION ON SAMPLES OF OLD ENGLISH

Topic – 061: Old English Literature: Phonology & Morphology

In literature, a language displays:

- Its full power
- Its ability to convey thoughts in a vivid form
- Its ability to record emotions

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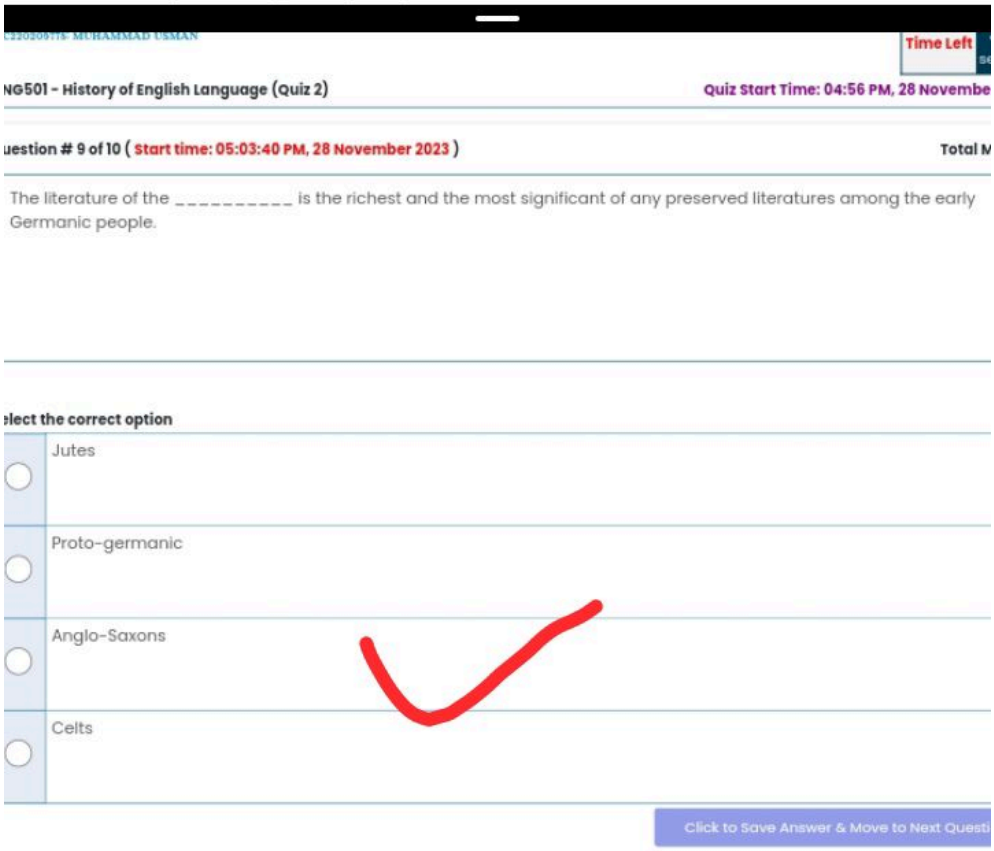
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The topic also provides certain examples to prove the points. For example:

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- Ic secge eac de, brodor Eadweard, nu du me tyses
- Asked, that you do unrighteously that you the



6:50 PM

524 B/s

intermarriage

- William's victory at Hastings was more than a mere substitution of one monarch for another.
- Norman prelates were gradually introduced into all important positions in the church. For example, the two archbishops were Normans. Also, English abbots were replaced.
- In 1075, 13 out of 21 abbots who signed the decrees of the Council of London were English. Interestingly twelve years later only three were left.

Topic – 068: Use of French Language and Literature

The Use of French by the Upper Class

The members of the new ruling class were sufficiently predominant to continue to use their own language. This was natural enough. For 200 years after the Norman Conquest, French remained the language of ordinary intercourse among the upper classes in England.

French Spread Through

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- Association with the ruling class: numerous people of English extraction found it to their advantage to learn French
- Distinction was not ethnic but was largely social

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An instructive parallel to the bilingual character of England in this period is furnished by the example of Belgium, today. Here, we find Flemish and French (Walloon) in use side by side (Flemish is only another name for the Dutch spoken in Belgium). Circumstances promoted the continued use of French. Until the beginning of the thirteenth century, there was a close connection of upper class between England and the continent. From the time of the conquest, the kings of England were likewise dukes of Normandy. English kings spent time there. The Conqueror and his sons were in France for about half of

ENG501 - History of English Language (Quiz 2) Quiz Start Time:

Question # 10 of 10 (Start time: 05:04:29 PM, 28 November 2023)

The French language spread through _____.

Select the correct option

- intermarriage
- trade
- settlement
- migration

Click to Save Answe

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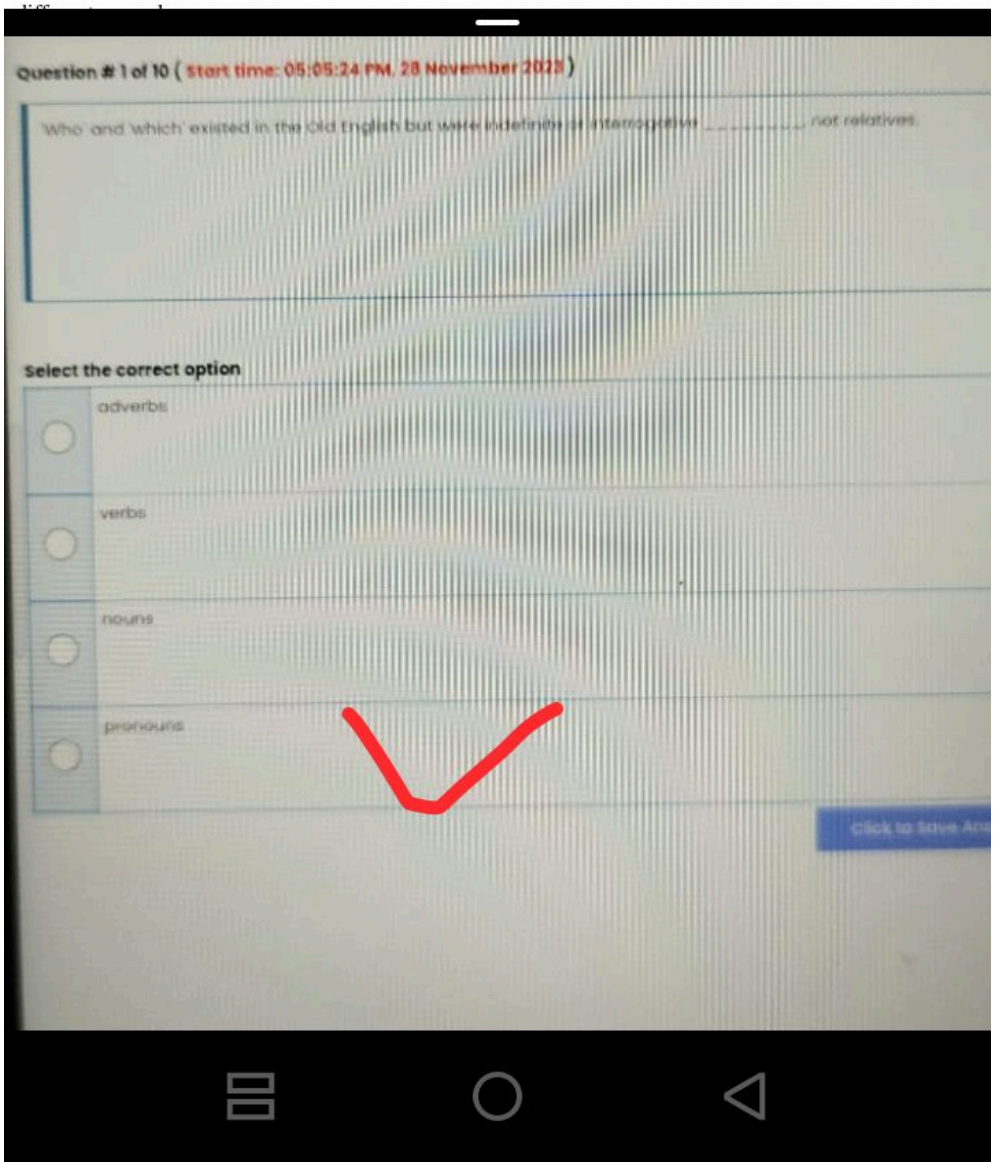
pronouns

- I say also to you, brother Eadweard, now you me of this
- Ic secge eac de, brodor Eadweard, nu du me tyses
- Asked, that you do unrighteously that you the
- Bade, tat ge dod unrihtlice tat ge da
- English customs abandon which your fathers held and
- Engliscan teawas forlatad te eowre faderasheoldon
- And heathen men's customs love who
- Hadenra manna teawas lufiad te
- Notice how relative clauses are introduced.

In the phrase 'se beo[t] amansumod te hadenra manna teawas hylt', we have the word *'te,' which I have is* glossed as 'who'.In the phrase 'ge da Engliscan teawas forlatad te eowre faderas heoldon' we see the same word, *'te,'* but here the Old English appropriate gloss is 'which', as it is referring to the *'teawas' ('customs')* rather than a person or people. *Who* and *which* did exist in Old English *(hwā, hwilc) but were indefinite or interrogative* pronouns, not relatives. For the relative function, old English used the indeclinable particle *'te', or the declinable pronoun 'se' (identical* in form with the definite article), or the two together.

Topic – 063: Old English: Sample 1 & Discussion

In this topic, a hands-on experience of analyzing an OLD ENGLISH TEXT was given with



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Language Significance Factors

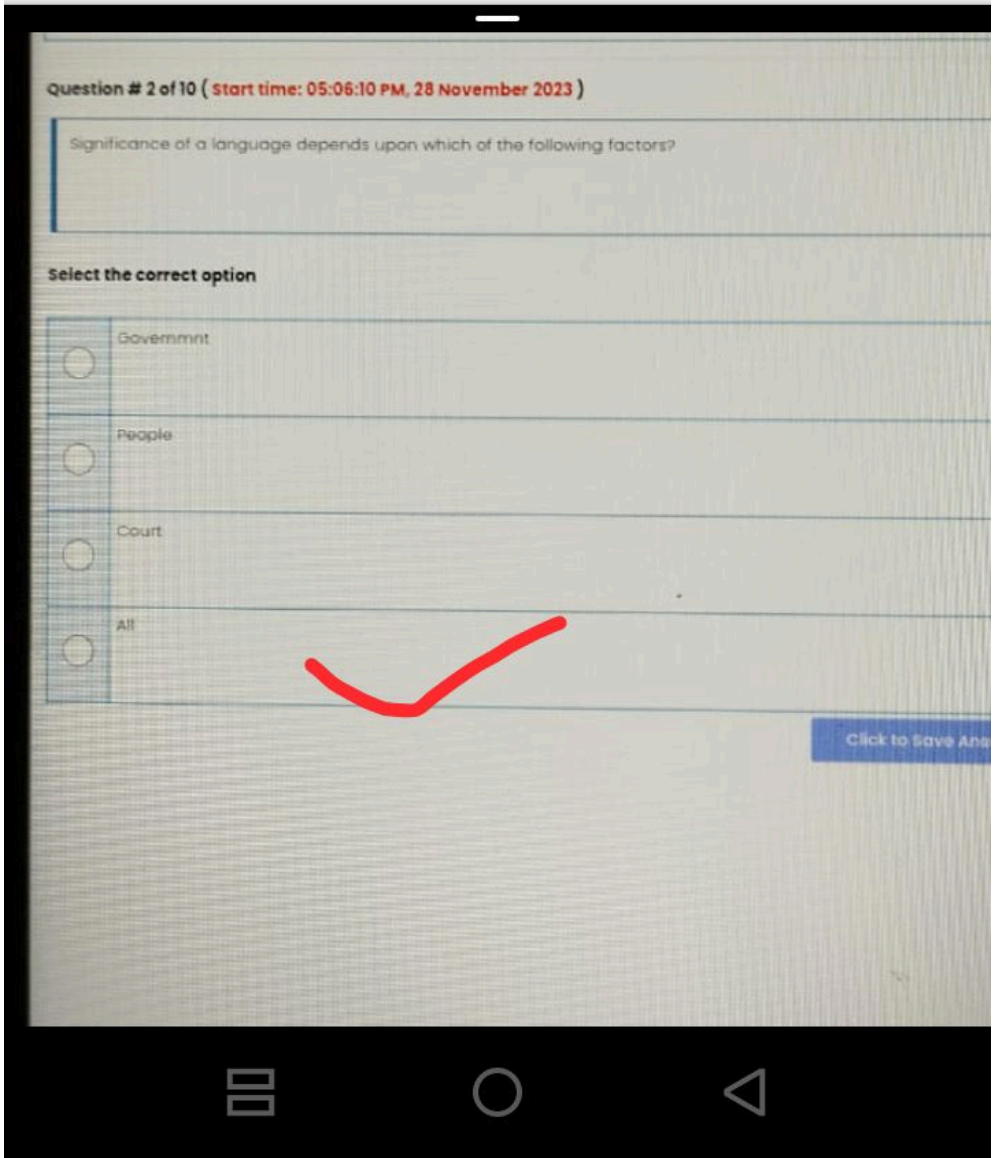
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to be reckoned

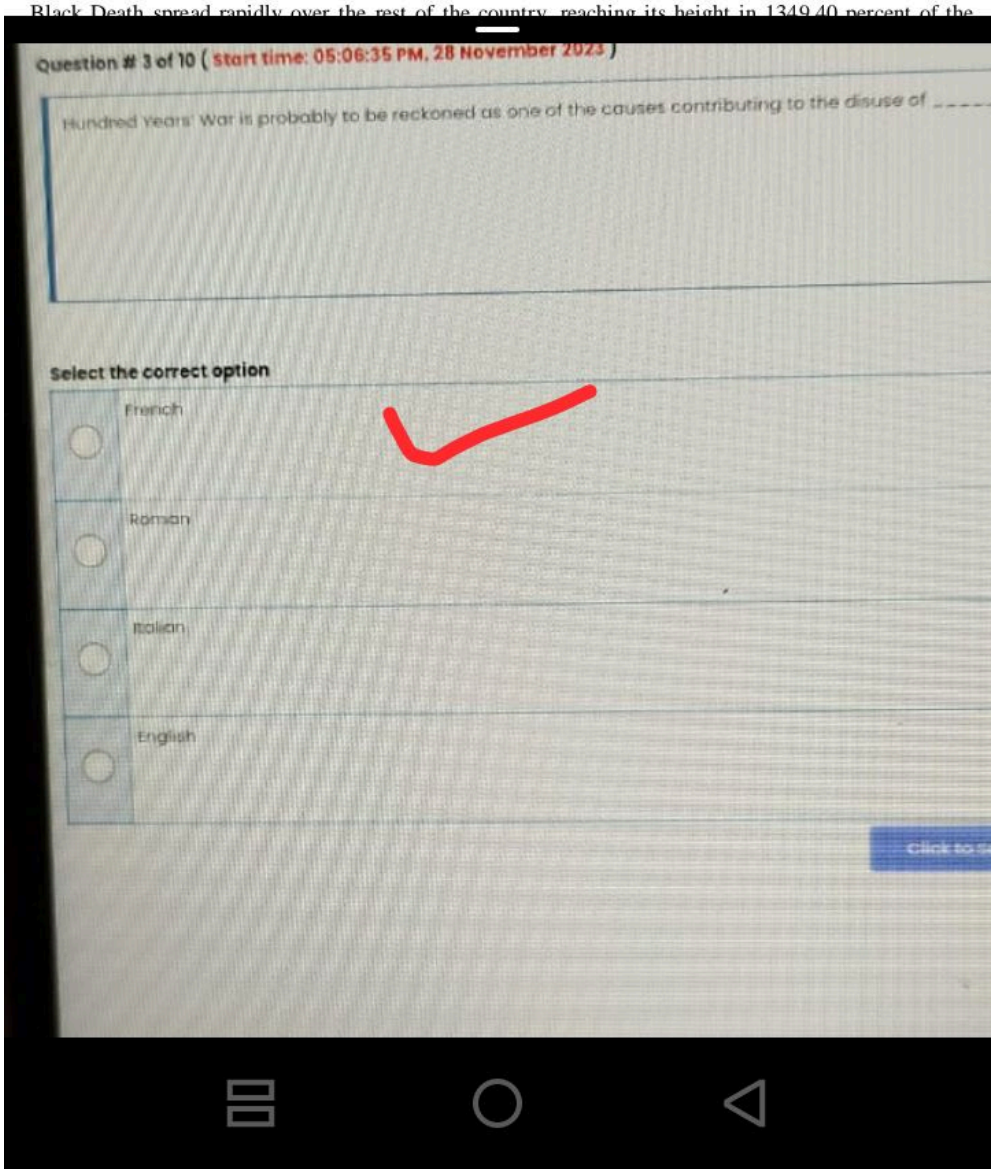
followed by a depressing period of reverses and the contest was interrupted by long periods of truce. In the reign of Henry V, England again enjoyed a brief period of success notably in the victory against great odds at Agincourt (1415). But the success did not continue after the young king's death, and the exploits of Joan of Arc (1429) marked the beginning of the end. Probably the intervals between the periods of actual fighting were too long and the hindrances to trade and other interaction too discouraging. The feeling that remained uppermost in the minds of most people was one of animosity, coupled with a sense of the inevitability of renewed hostilities. It was impossible to forget that French was the language of an enemy country Hundred Years' War is probably to be reckoned as one of the causes contributing to the disuse of French.

Topic – 075: The Rise of the Middle Class

What helped English to recover its former prestige?

- Improvement in the condition of the masses
- Rise of a substantial middle class

Since importance of a language largely depends upon the importance of people who speak it; with the rise of middle class English also had uplift in its status as their language. During the latter part of the Middle English period, the condition of the laboring classes was rapidly improving. Among the rural population villeinage was dying out. Fixed money payments were gradually substituted for the days' work. The process by which these changes were being brought about was greatly accelerated by an event that occurred in the year 1349. This event is known in the history as 'The Black Death'. It was in the summer of 1348 that in the Southwest of England, first case of this plague was reported. These were the first cases of a disease that in its contagiousness and fatality exceeded anything previously known. The Black Death spread rapidly over the rest of the country, reaching its height in 1349.40 percent of the



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Norsemen and Normans

Lesson

MOVING TOWARDS MIDDLE ENGLISH: THE NORMAN CONQUES (1066-1200)

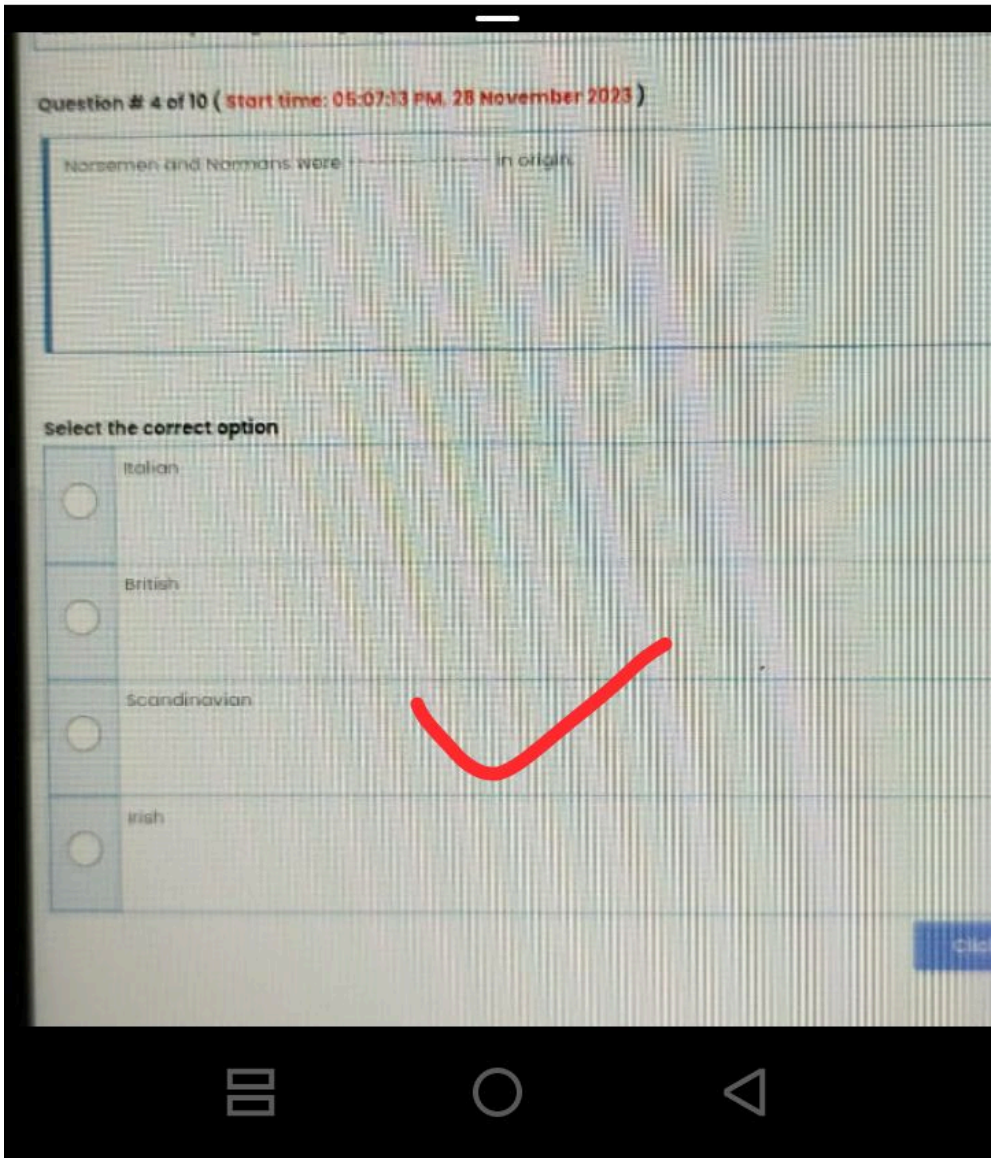
Topic – 066: Towards Middle English: The Norman Conquest (1066-1200)

Norsemen and Normans: During the latter part of the Old English period, two different group non-English speakers invaded the country. Both groups were Scandinavian in origin. Old Norse (ON) Old French (OF), Who were they? Their origin is discussed. What is the Norman Conquest, 1066? A what is its influence on English language? What would the language have been like if William Conqueror had not succeeded in making good his claim? It would have pursued much the same cours the other Germanic languages, retaining perhaps more of its inflections and preserving a predomina Germanic vocabulary. It is also discussed how word stock of English is affected by these events of history. If this event had not taken place, word formation in English would have been limited to characteristic methods of word formation from within language, and it would have been resulte incorporating less freely from outside the language.

Resultantly, English would have lacked the enormous number of French words that today m English seem, on the side of vocabulary, almost as much a Romance as a Germanic language. Norman Conquest changed the whole course of the English language.

Topic – 067: Origin of Normandy &Norman Settlement

Normandy: on the northern coast of France, directly across from England, a district extend some seventy-five miles back from the Channel. The name is derived from the bands of North-men



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spread rapidly

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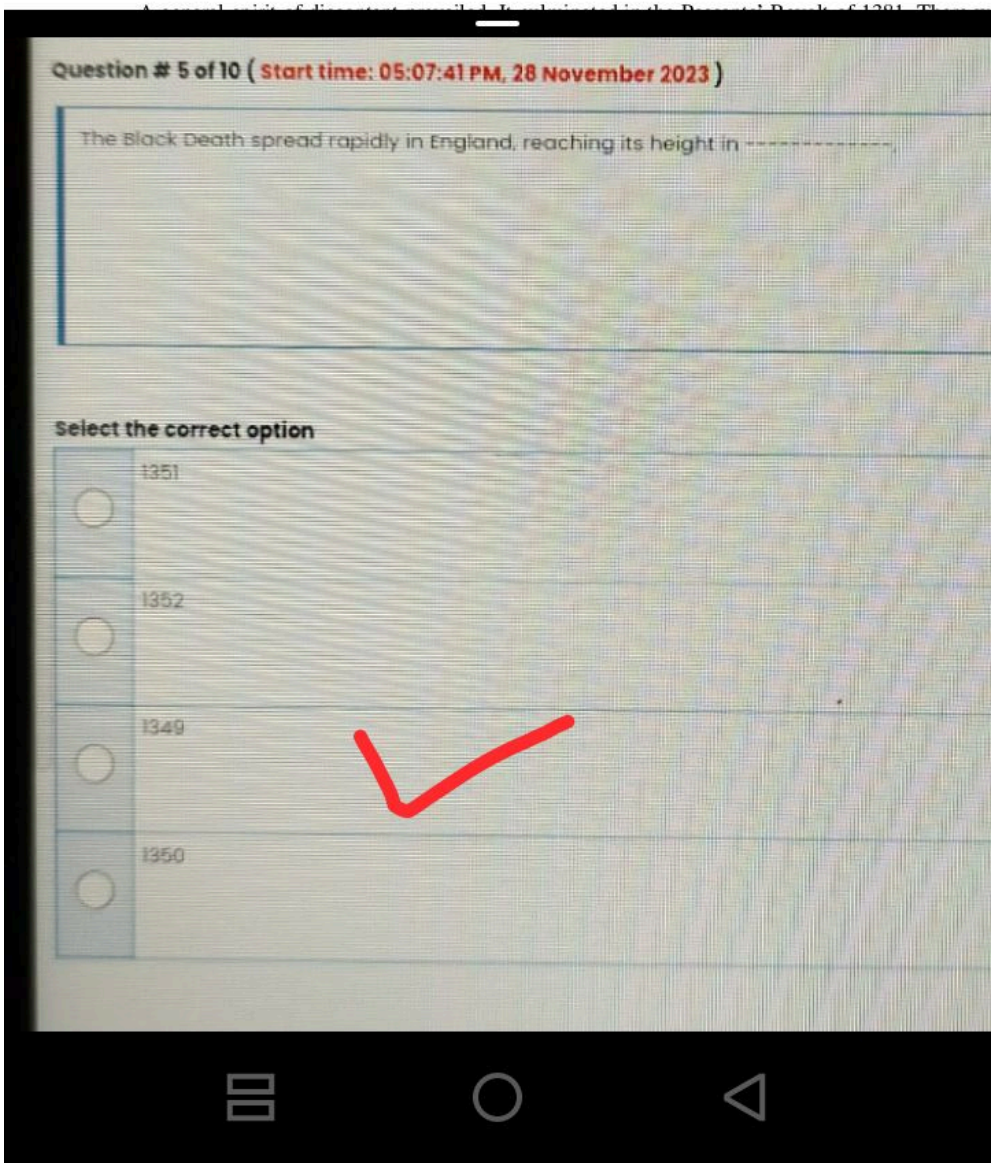
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Impact of the Black Death



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the language of the court

concern with continental affairs made French useful.

Topic – 070: Fusion and Diffusion of French and English

In the years following the Norman Conquest, the sting of defeat and the hardships incident to so great a political and social disturbance, they were gradually forgotten. People accepted the new order as something accomplished. They accepted it as a fact and adjusted themselves to it. The fusion of Normans and English was rapid, but not more rapid than national interest. When a distinction is made, it soon comes to be between the English, meaning all people of England, and the French, meaning the inhabitants of France. This early fusion of French and English in England is quite clear from a variety of evidences; for instance, one of the examples is marriages of Normans to English women.

Evidence

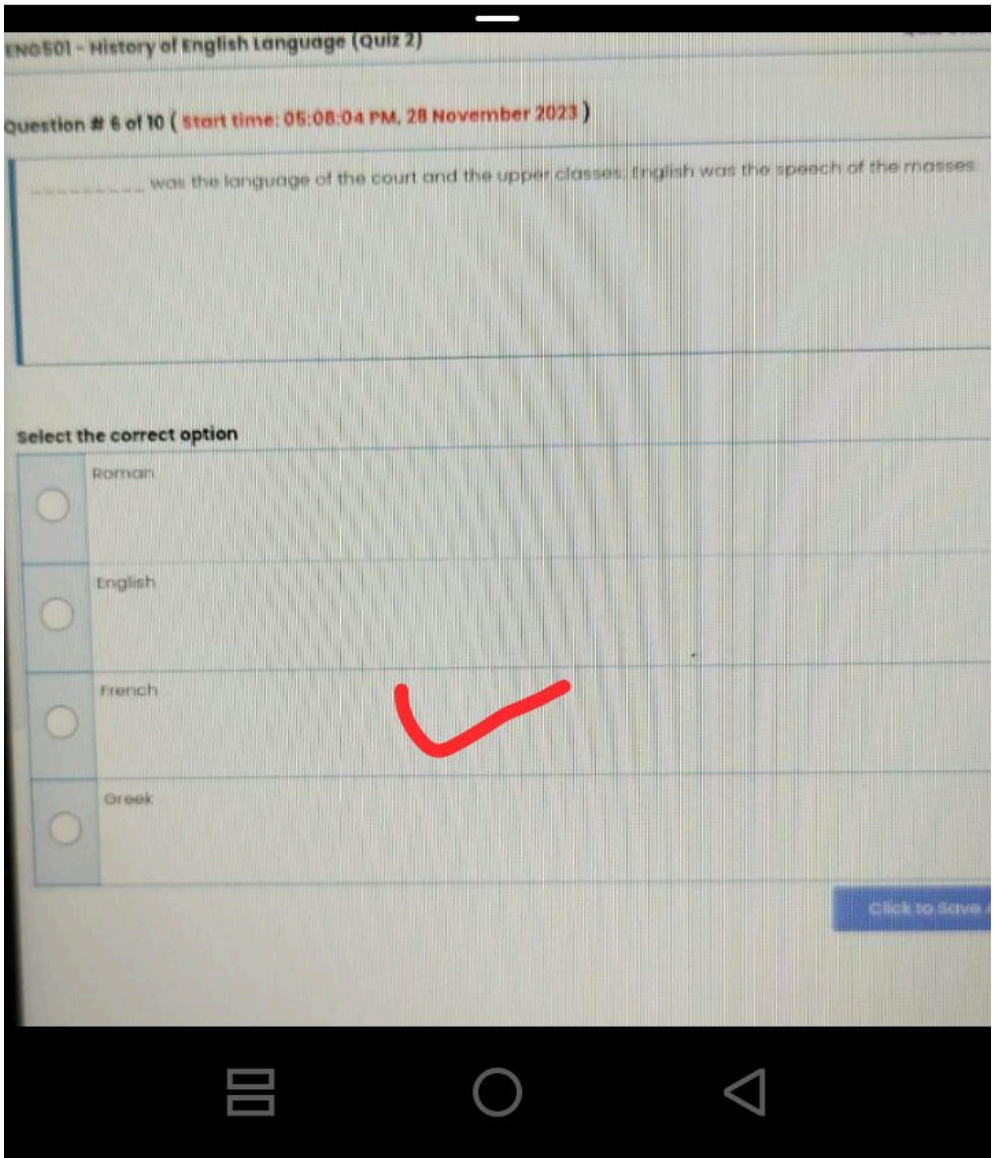
In (1072 – 1079) Wulfstan brought about some sort of spiritual federation between the monks of Worcester and six other English monasteries. In short, Norman nobles identified themselves with their new country, founded monasteries, and chose burial in their adopted land rather than in Normandy.

The fusion seems to have gone forward rapidly in the reign of Henry I. 'Now that the English and Normans have been dwelling together, marrying and giving in marriage, the two nations have become so mixed that it is scarcely possible to-day, speaking of free men, to tell who is English, who of Norman race.' French was the language of the court and the upper classes, English the speech of the mass of the peop[illegible].

The question to be asked is really twofold:

(1) When and how generally did the upper class learn English?

(2) How far down in the social scale was the knowledge of French at all general?



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mingle

Lesson 13

DISCUSSION ON SAMPLES OF OLD ENGLISH

Topic – 061: Old English Literature: Phonology & Morphology

In literature, a language displays:

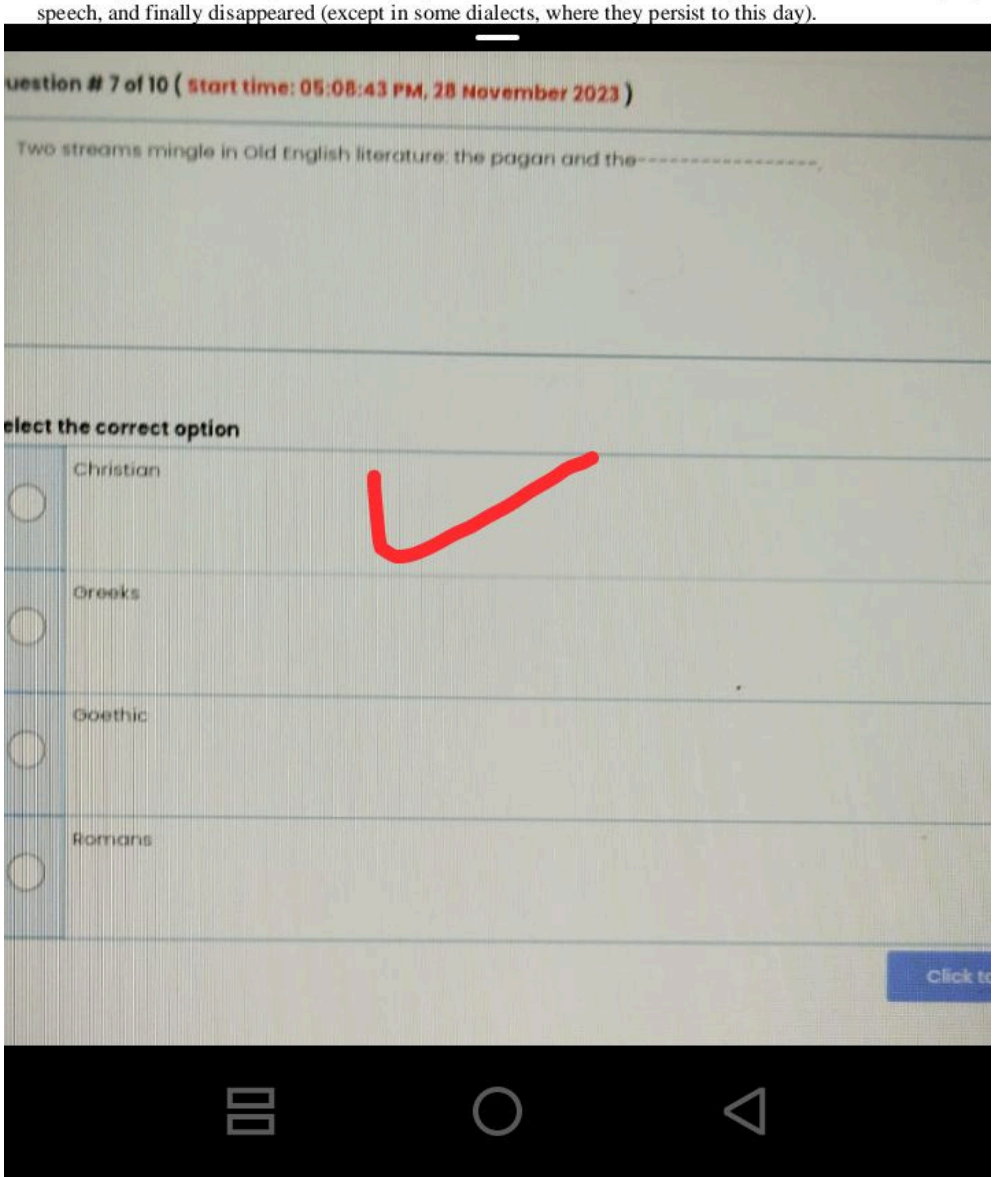
- Its full power
- Its ability to convey thoughts in a vivid form
- Its ability to record emotions

The literature of the Anglo-Saxons is the richest and the most significant of any preserved literatures among the early Germanic people. Two types of this literature were brought to England by the Germanic conquerors from their continental homes and preserved in oral tradition. It is influenced by reintroduction of Christianity into the southern part of the island at the end of the sixth century. Two streams mingle in Old English literature; these are pagan and the Christian. Both the traditions constantly overlay.

Topic – 062: Old English Literature: Semantics & Syntax

Use of Pronouns: *tū (singular)- gē (plural)*

Toda*y* we use *you* in both cases. In Old English, *thou and thee* were singular and *ye and you* were plural, but in Middle English times the custom arose of using *ye/you* as a polite or deferential way of addressing a single person, and this usage spread; *thou and thee* gradually dropped out of use in everyday speech, and finally disappeared (except in some dialects, where they persist to this day).



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the civilization of

11th Century

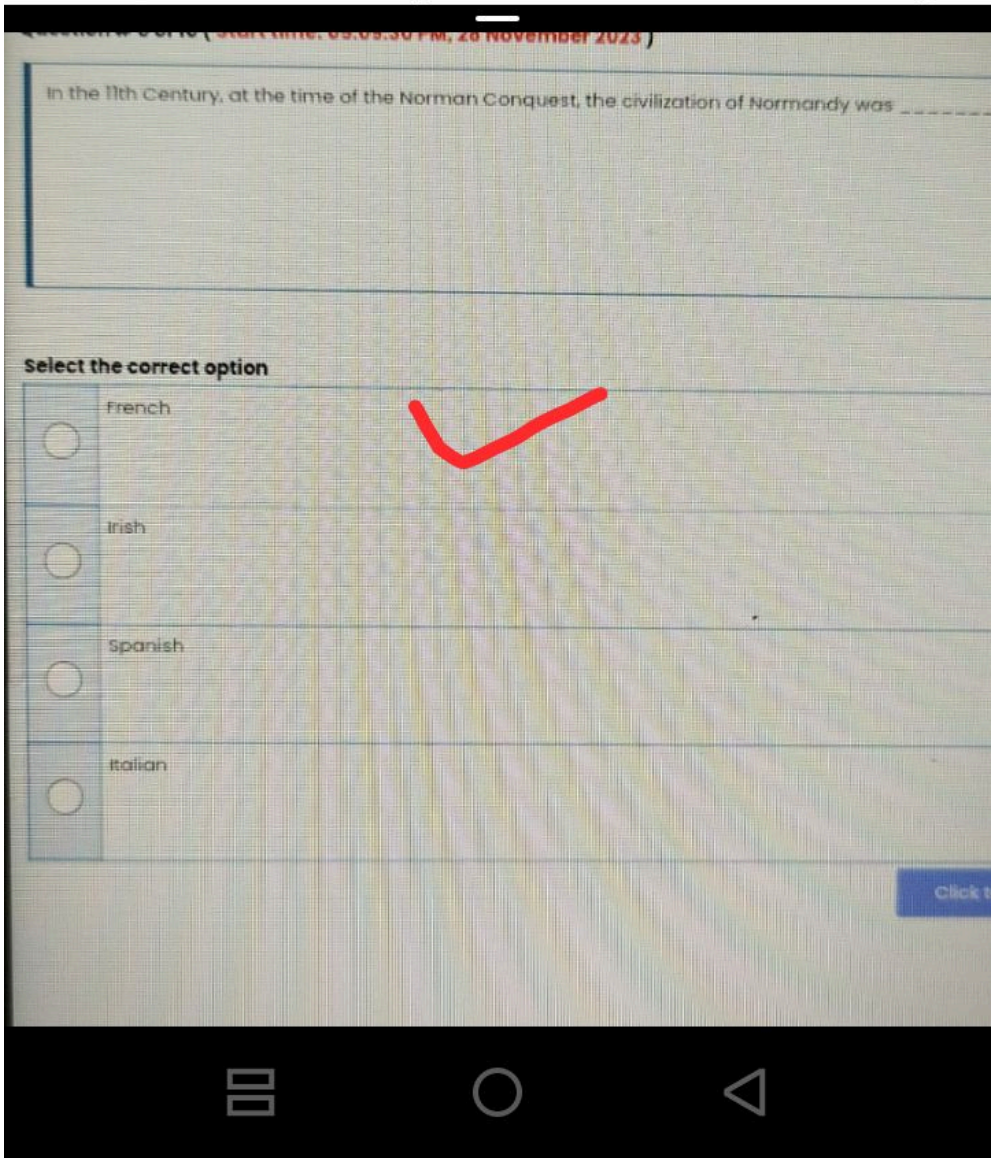
At the time of the Norman Conquest, the civilization of Normandy was French. Normans were most advanced people. Before Norman Conquest, there was a close contact between the two people. Æthelred (1002) married a Norman wife and during exile took refuge at the duke of Normandy. His son Edward, brought up in France, was more French than English. In 1042, Edward the Confessor was restored to the throne and he supported Norman friends. The result of all this was a strong French atmosphere. In this context, Edward died childless; it led to the issue of choice of a successor. Godwin, earl of the West Saxon emerged as successor, but he was challenged by William, the duke of Normandy.

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To cut it short, William had won the battle of Hastings, but had not yet attained the English crown. However, when the Southeast of England was burnt and the citizens of London surrendered, he was crowned on Christmas Day 1066.

Following important points about The Norman Settlement are worth readable:

- William's victory at Hastings was more than a mere substitution of one monarch for another.
- Norman prelates were gradually introduced into all important positions in the church. For example, the two archbishops were Normans. Also, English abbots were replaced.
- In 1075, 13 out of 21 abbots who signed the decrees of the Council of London were English.



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200 years after

The Use of French by the Upper Class

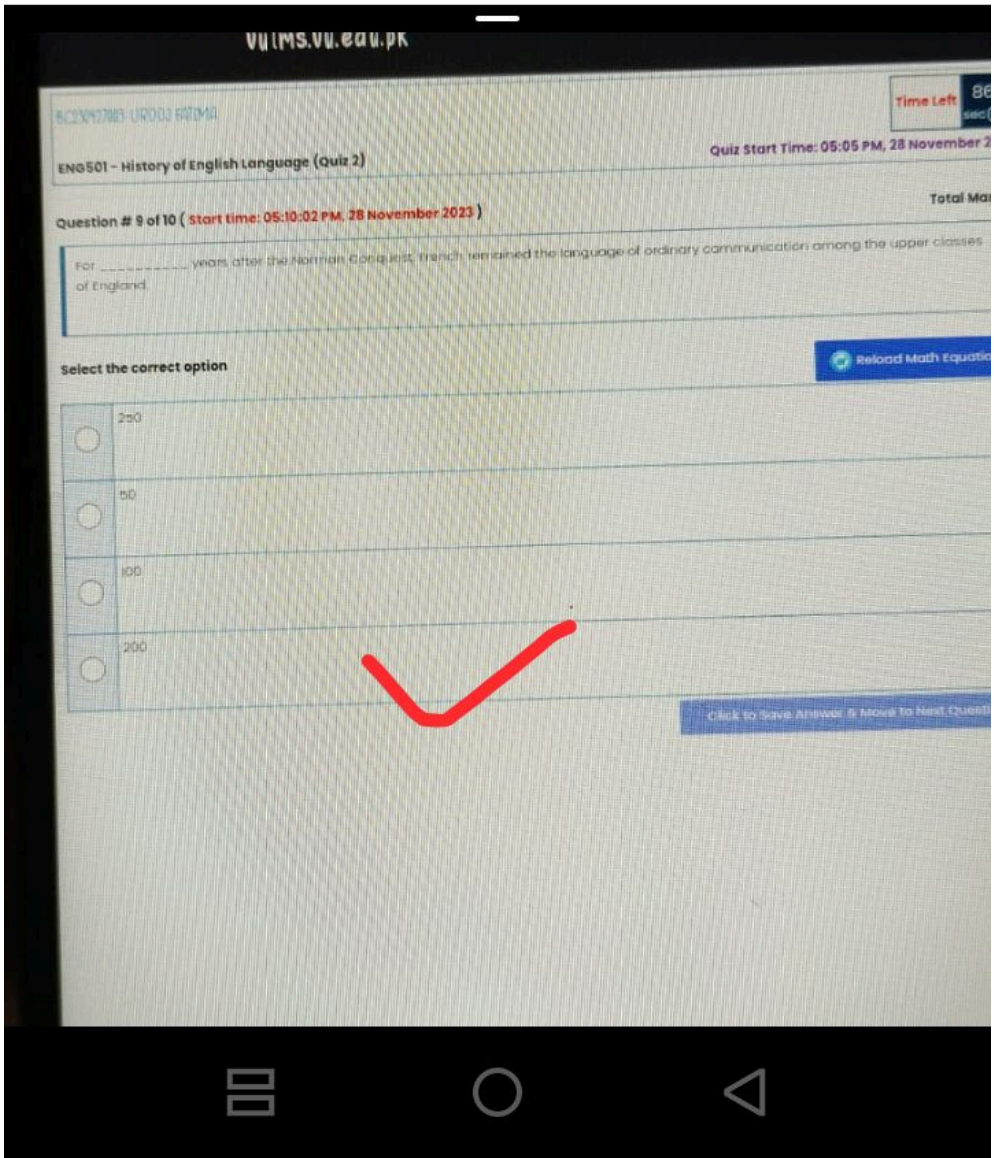
The members of the new ruling class were sufficiently predominant to continue to use their own language. This was natural enough. For 200 years after the Norman Conquest, French remained the language of ordinary intercourse among the upper classes in England.

French Spread Through

- Intermarriage
- Association with the ruling class: numerous people of English extraction found it to their advantage to learn French
- Distinction was not ethnic but was largely social

Language of the masses was English. A French soldier who settled on a manor with a few hundred English peasants would soon learn the language of the people among whom his lot was cast.

An instructive parallel to the bilingual character of England in this period is furnished by the example of Belgium, today. Here, we find Flemish and French (Walloon) in use side by side (Flemish is only another name for the Dutch spoken in Belgium). Circumstances promoted the continued use of French. Until the beginning of the thirteenth century, there was a close connection of upper class between England and the continent. From the time of the conquest, the kings of England were likewise dukes of Normandy. English kings spent time there. The Conqueror and his sons were in France for about half of their respective reigns. Except for Henry I, no English king until Edward IV (1461–1483) sought a wife in England, it is easy to see how continentally minded English royalty was and how natural the continued use of French at the English court was. Same was the case of nobility. The English nobility was an Anglo-French aristocracy. They had possessions on the continent. They frequently contracted continental marriages and spent much time in France. To please the court and the nobility, naturally all the literature that was written was also heavily influenced by French.



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socially inferior

Topic – 069: The Attitude Toward English

There is no reason to think that the preference that the governing class in England showed French was anything more than a natural result of circumstances. The idea that the newcomers v actively hostile to the English language is without foundation. It is true that English was now uncultivated tongue, the language of a socially inferior class. This session also discusses that till 1 what was happening? What was the attitude of the king and th pper classes? Why they v ere the reasons of indifference? They did not cultivate English, though acquaintance with it. The reason was that their activities in England did not necessitate it. Their cons concern with continental affairs made French useful.

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